

MICROFINANCE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

User Stories Document

User Stories Summary

This document defines 10 user stories for the Microfinance Management System. The system is a back office tool operated entirely by branch staff. Customers interact with Loan Officers, Cashiers, and Collections Officers in person never directly with the system. All data entry, workflow routing, and decision-making is performed by trained staff members.

Story ID	Title	Persona	Priority	Module
US-001	New Customer Registration and KYC Intake	Loan Officer	Critical	Client Registration
US-002	Group Formation and Group Loan Application Entry	Loan Officer	Critical	Group Loan Management
US-003	Loan Application and Underwriting Data Entry	Loan Officer	Critical	Loan Origination
US-004	Credit Committee Review and Loan Decision Recording	Branch Manager	Critical	Loan Origination
US-005	Loan Disbursement and Passbook / Schedule Issuance	Finance / Cashier	Critical	Finance & Cashiering
US-006	Repayment Collection and Receipt Posting	Collections & Recovery Officer / Finance Cashier	Critical	Repayment Management
US-007	Arrears Monitoring and Collections Follow-Up Logging	Collections & Recovery Officer	High	Collections
US-008	Individual Loan Graduation Assessment and Upgrade	Loan Officer + Branch Manager	High	Loan Origination
US-009	Daily Cash Reconciliation and Finance Close	Finance / Cashier	High	Finance & Cashiering
US-010	Branch Performance Dashboard and KPI Reporting	Branch Manager	High	Reporting & KPIs

Detailed User Stories

US-001 New Customer Registration and KYC Intake

Priority Critical	Module Client Registration	Primary User (Persona) Loan Officer	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Loan Officer, I want to register a new walk-in customer in the system capturing their identity, contact details, and basic eligibility information so that a complete client file is created from the first visit and no paper records are lost.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. The system provides a New Client Registration form with fields: full name, NIC/national ID number, photo upload, date of birth, residential address, phone number, and nearest landmark.
2. The Loan Officer can record the purpose of visit (loan inquiry, repayment, complaint, or other) at the time of registration.
3. The system auto generates a unique Client ID upon saving the record.
4. NIC number is validated for duplicates the system warns the officer if the NIC already exists in the database.
5. The system supports attaching scanned copies of ID documents (NIC, utility bill, photo) to the client file.
6. An incomplete registration can be saved as a draft and completed on a follow-up visit.
7. All registration entries are timestamped and attributed to the staff member who created the record.
8. The client file is accessible to all authorized staff (Loan Officer, Branch Manager, Admin) but not to Finance/Cashier for data minimization.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Walk-in customer arrives for the first time → Loan Officer opens New Client form → fills details → uploads NIC photo → saves → Client ID generated.
- Customer returns next day with missing documents → Loan Officer opens draft record → completes fields → finalizes registration.
- Customer already in the system under a different phone number → duplicate NIC warning appears → officer resolves by merging or flagging.

Dependencies • Document upload / storage module • Duplicate-check service • Role-based access control	Notes & Constraints This is a staff-operated screen. Customers do not access the system directly at any point. The Loan Officer sits with the customer and enters details on their behalf.
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US-002 Group Formation and Group Loan Application Entry

Priority Critical	Module Group Loan Management	Primary User (Persona) Loan Officer	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Loan Officer, I want to create a borrowing group of exactly 3 members in the system and link their individual loan applications so that all group members are tracked together and the joint guarantee relationship is properly recorded.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

9. The Loan Officer can create a new Group record by selecting exactly 3 registered clients from the client database.
10. The system assigns a unique Group ID and stores the group formation date and assigned meeting day/time.
11. Each group member's loan application is linked to the Group ID; the system prevents a member from being in more than one active group simultaneously.
12. The Loan Officer can record that group training (rights and obligations) has been completed, with a training date field.
13. A group guarantee agreement can be generated from a system template and marked as "signed and filed" by the officer.
14. The system displays all 3 member profiles side-by-side when viewing a group record.
15. The group record shows the current loan cycle number (Cycle 1, 2, 3+) based on completed loan history.
16. If any group member has an active overdue balance, the system displays a warning before allowing a new group application to proceed.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Loan Officer selects 3 registered clients → creates group → assigns meeting schedule → marks training complete → group ready for loan application.
- Officer tries to add a client who is already in another active group → system blocks and shows the conflict.
- Returning group applies for Cycle 2 → system shows previous cycle history → officer confirms all members still active before proceeding.

Dependencies • Client registration module (US-001) • Loan application module • Document template engine	Notes & Constraints All 3 group members receive the same loan amount in a cycle. The group guarantee means each member is liable for the others' repayments. This must be clearly flagged in the system when any member falls overdue.
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US-003 Loan Application and Underwriting Data Entry

Priority Critical	Module Loan Origination	Primary User (Persona) Loan Officer	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Loan Officer, I want to capture a customer's loan application details including business cashflow, loan purpose, and required documents in the system so that the credit committee has a complete, consistent application pack to review without needing to handle loose paper files.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

17. The Loan Officer can create a new loan application linked to a client ID (individual) or group ID (group loan).
18. The application form captures: loan purpose, requested amount, proposed loan tenor (weeks), repayment frequency, business description, and monthly income/expense summary.
19. A cashflow worksheet is available within the application for the Loan Officer to enter income, business expenses, household expenses, and net surplus.
20. The system calculates and displays a simple affordability indicator (net surplus vs. proposed weekly repayment).
21. The Loan Officer can record the KYC document checklist status: NIC (received/pending), proof of address (received/pending), business evidence (received/pending), group guarantee (received/pending).
22. A credit memo text field allows the Loan Officer to type their assessment summary and risk observations.
23. The application can be saved as "Draft," "Submitted for Review," or "Pending Documents."
24. The Branch Manager is notified (via dashboard or system alert) when an application is submitted for review.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Loan Officer completes cashflow interview with customer → enters figures in system → affordability shows positive surplus → submits to Branch Manager.
- Documents are still missing → application saved as "Pending Documents" → customer given a checklist printout → Loan Officer follows up next visit.
- Group application: Loan Officer creates one application per member, all linked to the same Group ID, with the same loan amount pre-filled.

Dependencies • Client/Group registration module • Document checklist module • Branch Manager notification	Notes & Constraints The Loan Officer conducts the cashflow interview face-to-face or during a field visit. The system is used to record the results — not to automate the interview itself.
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US-004 Credit Committee Review and Loan Decision Recording

Priority Critical	Module Loan Origination	Primary User (Persona) Branch Manager	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Branch Manager, I want to review submitted loan applications in the system and record the credit committee's decision — approved, declined, or conditionally approved — so that every decision is documented with a rationale and is traceable for audit purposes.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

25. The Branch Manager can view a list of all applications with status "Submitted for Review," sorted by submission date.
26. Clicking an application shows the full application pack: client profile, cashflow worksheet, KYC checklist status, credit memo, and loan history (if existing customer).
27. The decision form captures: decision (Approved / Declined / Conditional Approval), approved amount, approved tenor, any conditions attached, and the date of the committee meeting.
28. A "Committee Members Present" field captures at least 2 names for decisions above a configurable approval threshold.
29. Decision rationale is a required text field before the record can be saved.
30. Upon approval, the system automatically generates the repayment schedule and makes it available to the Finance/Cashier for disbursement preparation.
31. Upon decline, a decline reason is recorded and the Loan Officer is notified to communicate this to the customer.
32. Maker-checker control: the Loan Officer who submitted the application cannot be the one who records the approval decision.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Branch Manager reviews 3 submitted applications at weekly committee → records Approved for 2, Conditional for 1 → system generates repayment schedules for the 2 approved.
- Manager tries to approve an application they created themselves → system blocks and requires a second authorized user.
- Conditional approval: condition is "submit business photo before disbursement" → condition is recorded → Finance is blocked from disbursing until condition is marked cleared.

Dependencies • Loan application module (US-003) • Repayment schedule generator • Maker-checker access controls • Finance disbursement module	Notes & Constraints No loan disbursement can occur without a recorded Approved decision. This is a hard system control, not just a policy.
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US-005 Loan Disbursement and Passbook / Schedule Issuance

Priority Critical	Module Finance & Cashiering	Primary User (Persona) Finance / Cashier	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Finance/Cashier, I want to process and record a loan disbursement in the system after the Branch Manager has confirmed approval and all conditions are cleared so that the disbursement is posted to the loan ledger on the same day and the customer's repayment schedule is immediately available.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

33. The Cashier can only access the Disbursement screen for applications with status "Approved" and all conditions marked as cleared.
34. The disbursement record captures: disbursement date, disbursement method (cash / bank transfer), amount disbursed, and the staff member processing it.
35. The system requires a second authorized person (Branch Manager or delegated officer) to confirm disbursement before it is posted → maker checker control.
36. Upon confirmed disbursement, the loan ledger is updated immediately with: loan start date, disbursed amount, and full repayment schedule.
37. A printable repayment schedule (showing each installment date and amount) is generated and can be handed to the customer.
38. A passbook update record is created then the Cashier marks whether a physical passbook was updated.
39. The loan status changes to "Active" and the first due date is set in the system.
40. The system prevents disbursement of the same loan application more than once.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Manager has approved loan → Cashier opens disbursement screen → confirms amount → Manager co-signs in system → loan is disbursed → schedule printed → passbook updated.
- Condition not yet cleared → Cashier cannot access disbursement → system shows blocking message and outstanding condition.
- Group loan: Cashier disburses to all 3 members simultaneously; system creates 3 individual loan ledger entries all linked to the same Group ID.

Dependencies • Credit decision module (US-004) • Loan ledger / accounting module • Repayment schedule generator • Maker-checker controls	Notes & Constraints The Finance/Cashier role must be separate from the Loan Officer and Branch Manager for this transaction. Cash disbursements must be reconciled in the daily cash report.
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US-006 Repayment Collection and Receipt Posting

Priority Critical	Module Repayment Management	Primary User (Persona) Collections & Recovery Officer / Finance Cashier	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Collections Officer or Cashier, I want to record customer repayment collections in the system and immediately generate a receipt so that the loan ledger is up to date, the customer has proof of payment, and the daily cash reconciliation is accurate.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

41. Staff can search for a customer by Client ID, NIC, name, or phone number to pull up their active loan account.
42. The repayment entry screen shows: next installment due date, amount due, total outstanding balance, and any overdue amount.
43. The staff member enters: amount received, payment date, and payment method (cash / mobile money / bank).
44. The system generates a receipt number and allows printing or saving a receipt record.
45. Partial payments are allowed and the system calculates and displays the remaining overdue or outstanding balance after posting.
46. If a customer pays more than the due installment, the system prompts the staff member to confirm whether the excess is an advance installment or overpayment.
47. The loan ledger is updated immediately upon posting; the payment appears in the customer's repayment history.
48. The daily cash total is updated in real time and visible to the Finance/Cashier for reconciliation at end of day.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Customer visits branch to pay weekly installment → Cashier searches by name → confirms amount → posts payment → prints receipt → customer leaves with receipt.
- Group meeting repayment: Collections Officer collects from all 3 members → posts 3 separate payments under each client ID in quick succession.
- Customer pays a partial amount → system records partial payment → remaining overdue balance is flagged → Collections Officer is notified.

Dependencies • Loan ledger module • Receipt generation • Daily cash reconciliation module	Notes & Constraints Every repayment must be receipted. Staff cannot post a payment without generating a receipt. Physical meetings (weekly group meetings) are where most collections happen then the officer records these on return to the office or via a device in the field.
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US-007 Arrears Monitoring and Collections Follow-Up Logging

Priority High	Module Collections	Primary User (Persona) Collections & Recovery Officer	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Collections & Recovery Officer, I want to see a daily list of all overdue accounts organized by how many days they are past due so that I can prioritize my follow-up calls and visits, log each contact attempt, and record any promise to pay commitments made by the borrower.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

49. The system displays an Arrears Dashboard showing all active loans with a missed installment, grouped into buckets: 1-7 days, 8-30 days, 31-90 days, and over 90 days overdue.
50. Each overdue account shows: client name, Group ID (if group loan), days overdue, total overdue amount, and last contact date.
51. The Collections Officer can open any account and log a contact attempt: date, contact method (phone / field visit / group meeting), outcome (reached / not reached / promised to pay / refused).
52. When outcome is "promised to pay," the system captures the promised amount and promised date, and schedules a follow up reminder for the officer.
53. If a promise to pay is broken (promised date passes without payment), the system flags it and increments a "broken promises" counter for the account.
54. After 3 broken promises or 30+ days overdue, the system prompts the officer to escalate the case to the Branch Manager.
55. For group loans, the system shows all 3 members' repayment status together so the officer can assess whether to activate joint guarantee follow-up.
56. All contact attempts and notes are stored in a contact log visible to the Branch Manager.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Officer opens arrears dashboard Monday morning → sorts by days overdue → calls customers in the 8–30 day bucket first → logs each call outcome.
- Customer promises to pay Thursday → officer records PTP → Thursday passes with no payment → system flags broken promise → officer escalates to manager.
- Group loan: one member is 15 days overdue → officer reviews all 3 members' status → decides to contact the group guarantors → logs visit note.

Dependencies • Loan ledger / repayment schedule • Contact log module • Branch Manager escalation notification • PTP tracking module	Notes & Constraints The Collections Officer is the human who contacts customers. The system supports this by organizing information and logging outcomes, it does not contact customers automatically.
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US-008 Individual Loan Graduation Assessment and Upgrade

Priority High	Module Loan Origination	Primary User (Persona) Loan Officer + Branch Manager	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Loan Officer, I want the system to flag when a group loan customer qualifies for graduation to an individual loan based on their repayment history so that I can proactively offer the right product to strong customers without manually reviewing every client file.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

57. The system marks a client as a "Graduation Candidate" when they meet the configured graduation rule (e.g., completed at least 1 loan cycle with zero or minimal late payments).
58. A Graduation Candidate flag appears on the client's profile, visible to the Loan Officer and Branch Manager.
59. The Loan Officer can open a Graduation Assessment form linked to the client's existing record, prefilled with their loan and repayment history.
60. The assessment form captures additional fields required for individual loan appraisal: household income, other debts, references, and business verification notes.
61. The completed graduation assessment is submitted to the credit committee via the same review workflow used for standard applications (US-004).
62. Upon approval, the loan is created as an "Individual Loan" type with its own repayment schedule separate from any prior group loan history.
63. The system records the graduation event in the client's history with date and approving officer.
64. If the customer does not yet qualify, the system shows the gap (e.g., "1 more on-time installment needed") so the officer can communicate a clear timeline.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Loan Officer reviews client list → sees "Graduation Candidate" badge on 2 clients → opens their files → initiates graduation assessment for both.
- Client has one late payment → system shows they do not yet qualify → officer sees the gap message → informs the client of what is needed.
- Graduation application submitted → Branch Manager reviews → approves → individual loan disbursed → group loan history preserved in system.

Dependencies • Loan history module • Graduation rule configuration (admin) • Loan application module (US-003) • Credit decision module (US-004)	Notes & Constraints The graduation rule thresholds (number of cycles, maximum late payments allowed) should be configurable by the Branch Manager or admin without requiring a system code change.
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US-009 Daily Cash Reconciliation and Finance Close

Priority High	Module Finance & Cashiering	Primary User (Persona) Finance / Cashier	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Finance/Cashier, I want to run a daily cash reconciliation in the system comparing total cash received against total disbursements and expected cash on hand so that any discrepancy is identified and resolved before the branch closes, and a daily finance report is produced for the Branch Manager.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

65. The system provides a Daily Cash Summary screen showing: opening cash balance, total repayments received (by payment method), total disbursements made, and calculated closing cash balance.
66. The Cashier enters the physical cash count at end of day; the system compares this to the calculated closing balance and highlights any variance.
67. If there is a variance, the Cashier can add a reconciliation note explaining the reason; the variance remains visible on the report and cannot be hidden.
68. The daily report lists all transactions posted during the day: receipts (with receipt number, client, amount) and disbursements (with loan ID, client, amount).
69. The Branch Manager can review and digitally sign off on the daily reconciliation; sign-off is timestamped.
70. Once signed off, the day's records are locked and cannot be edited by branch staff.
71. The Finance/Cashier can print or export the daily report to PDF or Excel.
72. Any bank deposit made during the day is recorded separately with a deposit slip reference number.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- End of day: Cashier opens daily summary → all receipts and disbursements auto-populated → enters physical cash count → no variance → Manager signs off → records locked.
- Variance of \$5 found → Cashier adds note "rounding difference on group payment" → Manager reviews → signs off with note acknowledged.
- Manager is out of office → system allows delegated sign-off by authorized second officer → delegation is logged.

Dependencies • Repayment posting module (US-006) • Disbursement module (US-005) • Loan ledger • Manager sign-off / approval workflow	Notes & Constraints Daily reconciliation is a non-negotiable control. The system must prevent editing of posted transactions after end-of-day sign-off. Variances are never auto-resolved.
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US-010 Branch Performance Dashboard and KPI Reporting

Priority High	Module Reporting & KPIs	Primary User (Persona) Branch Manager	Customer Interaction In-person via staff
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USER STORY

As a Branch Manager, I want a management dashboard that shows key performance indicators including portfolio size, PAR30, repayment rate, active clients, and overdue trends so that I can make informed decisions at weekly credit and arrears review meetings without manually compiling reports from spreadsheets.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

73. The dashboard displays a real-time summary: total active loans, total outstanding portfolio value, number of clients, number of active groups, and number of applications pending decision.
74. PAR30 (Portfolio at Risk loans with any installment more than 30 days overdue) is calculated and displayed as both a count and a percentage of total portfolio.
75. A repayment rate metric shows the percentage of installments due in the current week/month that have been collected.
76. The overdue trend chart shows PAR30 over the past 12 weeks so the manager can see whether the portfolio is improving or deteriorating.
77. A staff activity summary shows: number of applications submitted, collections posted, and contact attempts logged per staff member for the current week.
78. The Branch Manager can filter the dashboard by date range, loan type (group / individual), and loan cycle.
79. The KPI pack can be exported to PDF or Excel for sharing with the head office or owner.
80. The system generates a weekly KPI report automatically every Monday morning, which the Manager can review and annotate before distributing.

SCENARIOS / EXAMPLES

- Monday morning: Manager opens dashboard before the weekly credit committee meeting → reviews PAR30, new applications, and collections rate → walks the team through the numbers.
- PAR30 has increased 3 weeks in a row → Manager drills into the overdue list → identifies 2 repeat offenders → assigns escalated follow-up to Collections Officer.
- Owner requests a monthly portfolio report → Manager exports KPI pack to PDF → shares with owner without needing to build a spreadsheet manually.

Dependencies	Notes & Constraints
• Loan ledger • Repayment module • Collections / arrears module • Staff activity logging • Export / PDF module	PAR30 is the primary portfolio health metric. The dashboard must be usable by a non-technical Branch Manager. All calculations should be clearly labelled with their formula or definition accessible via a tooltip or help text.

